

ProteinGPT — Product Strategy Breakdown

Problems, personas, prioritization, solutions, and success metrics

1. The Problem

Core Job to Be Done: Help me quickly pick a protein product that fits my goal, budget, and diet — without getting scammed or overwhelmed — and tell me why I should trust the pick.

External problems (the market / job)

- Decision paralysis across 100+ SKUs on 6+ platforms (Amazon, Flipkart, Nutrabay, brand sites)
- Keyword search can't parse intent/constraints ("clean, no bloating, under Rs. 2,000, beginner")
- Low trust in label claims — the Indian supplement market has real adulteration/mislabeling issues, so "best" is unverifiable by eye
- Dietary contradictions people don't know to check for (vegan whey, keto mass gainer)
- Users with medical conditions self-selecting supplements with no safety check

Problems inside the product itself (current MVP gaps)

- Only 24 products in the knowledge base — thin relative to the "100+ products, 6+ platforms" problem it claims to solve; if a user's preferred brand isn't in there, trust breaks on the first query
- No path to purchase — it recommends but can't close the loop (no buy link, no checkout redirect)
- Static, hand-authored catalogue (JSON) — prices/stock go stale, no live sync with actual retailers
- No persistent user profile — goals/diet/budget aren't remembered across sessions, so every chat restarts from zero
- Medical guardrails only cover 3 named conditions (kidney, diabetes, pregnancy) — narrow safety net
- No feedback loop to confirm a recommendation actually led to a satisfying purchase

2. The Users Who Might Be Using the Product (Personas)

Persona	Description	Core need
The Overwhelmed Beginner	New to lifting, doesn't know brands/certs, asking things like "protein for skinny guy who wants to gain weight fast"	Simple, jargon-free guidance
The Budget Optimizer	Price-sensitive, wants best protein-per-rupee, will ask "best whey under 2000"	Transparent value scoring
The Restricted Shopper	Vegan, lactose-intolerant, keto, allergen-sensitive	Contradiction-catching, correct filtering
The Skeptical Label-Reader	Distrustful of marketing, wants certs/lab data before buying	Verifiable trust signals
The Medically Cautious User	Has a condition (kidney disease, diabetes, pregnancy) and is looking for supplement advice	Safe refusal + doctor redirect

Persona	Description	Core need
The Repeat Buyer	Comes back monthly to restock or switch products	Continuity/memory across visits

3. The Approach — Prioritizing Problems by Estimated Impact

Ranked by how directly each problem blocks the core value prop (trust + decision speed) and how many users it likely touches:

Rank	Problem	Why it's high/low impact
1	Thin catalogue (24 SKUs)	Undermines the entire premise ("cuts through 100+ products"). If the user's product isn't there, they leave immediately. Affects nearly every user.
2	No path to purchase	This is the actual moment of value capture — without it, ProteinGPT is a research tool, not a shopping tool. Blocks monetization entirely.
3	Trust/verification of claims	In a market known for mislabeling, a "value score" without verifiable cert/lab data is just another unverified claim — same trust gap it claims to fix.
4	Stale/static pricing	Budget queries ("under Rs. 2000") are a primary hook; a wrong price at checkout destroys trust instantly.
5	No persistent user profile	Hurts retention/repeat use more than first-session trust — real but secondary.
6	Narrow medical guardrail scope	Low reach (few users trigger it) but very high severity if it fails — a safety issue, not a growth one.

4. Solutions for the Top Problems

- **Catalogue expansion** — pull from retailer APIs/affiliate feeds (Amazon PA-API, Flipkart affiliate, Nutrabay) instead of a hand-curated JSON; automate refresh so breadth scales without manual entry.
- **Buy-now / affiliate deep links** — attach a real purchase path (affiliate redirect) to every recommendation, closing the loop from "recommend" to "buy."
- **Certification/verification layer** — surface FSSAI registration, third-party lab test batches (e.g., Informed-Sport/Labdoor-style data) per product, and visibly flag unverified claims instead of presenting all specs as equally trustworthy.
- **Live pricing pipeline** — replace the static JSON with a scheduled scrape/webhook sync so price and stock reflect reality at query time.
- **Persistent user profile** — store goal/diet/budget/allergy prefs in the existing Supabase auth layer so returning users don't re-explain themselves.
- **Expanded medical guardrails** — broaden the condition list and add a general "consult a doctor" fallback for any health-flagged query the system doesn't explicitly recognize, rather than only 3 hardcoded conditions.

5. Prioritizing the Solutions (Impact vs. Effort)

Priority	Solution	Impact	Effort	Rationale
P0	Expand medical guardrails	High (safety)	Low	Cheap to ship, directly reduces worst-case risk
P0	Persistent user profile	Medium-High	Low-Medium	Supabase auth already exists; mostly schema + UI work
P1	Buy-now / affiliate links	High	Medium	Requires partner/affiliate integration, but closes the monetization loop
P1	Catalogue expansion via retailer APIs	High	High	Biggest lift, but most central to the core value prop
P2	Live pricing pipeline	Medium-High	High	Depends on catalogue-expansion work; sequenced after it
P2	Certification/verification layer	Medium	Medium	Valuable but can follow once catalogue data is real, not static

Suggested sequence: guardrails + user profile first (quick, low-risk wins) → affiliate/buy-now (revenue-closing) → catalogue + live pricing (the real scaling investment) → verification layer (trust deepening once data pipeline exists).

6. Metrics to Measure Success

- **Activation:** % of chat sessions that reach a concrete top-pick recommendation (vs. abandoned/no-match)
- **Coverage:** % of queries answered from catalogue vs. "not found" fallback (tracks catalogue-expansion impact directly)
- **Trust/engagement:** click-through rate from recommendation → product detail; thumbs up/down or explicit satisfaction rating per response
- **Conversion:** click-through to buy-now link; downstream purchase conversion once affiliate tracking exists
- **Retention:** returning users per month, repeat sessions per user (tests whether persistent profile moves the needle)
- **Safety:** audited accuracy of medical-condition refusals (should stay at ~100%, zero tolerance for false negatives)
- **Price accuracy:** variance between displayed price and live retailer price (once pricing pipeline ships)
- **Qualitative:** NPS or short in-chat feedback prompt after each recommendation